

Sri Lanka is an island nation located in South Asia, in the Indian Ocean, just southeast of India. Known for its rich cultural heritage, it has a history spanning over 2,500 years, shaped by ancient kingdoms, Buddhism, and periods of Portuguese, Dutch, and British colonial rule. This long history has left behind a strong cultural identity, with traditions, festivals, and architecture still deeply preserved today.

The country is famous for its diverse landscapes, ranging from golden sandy beaches and coastal plains to lush rainforests and central highlands covered with tea plantations. The cool hill country areas like Nuwara Eliya and Ella contrast sharply with the warm coastal regions, making Sri Lanka a destination with varied climates in a small geographic area. It is also home to rich biodiversity, including elephants, leopards, and a wide range of bird species found in national parks such as Yala and Wilpattu.

Sri Lanka's capital is Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte, while Colombo serves as the commercial and financial center of the country. The economy is

driven by tourism, agriculture—especially tea, rubber, and coconut—and growing service sectors. The country is also known for its world-renowned Ceylon tea, which is one of its biggest exports.

Culturally, Sri Lanka is a blend of ethnicities and religions, mainly Sinhalese and Tamil communities, with Buddhism being the predominant religion. Major cultural landmarks include ancient cities like Anuradhapura and Polonnaruwa, and iconic sites such as the Sigiriya rock fortress, which attracts visitors from around the world. Festivals like Sinhala and Tamil New Year, Vesak, and Deepavali reflect the island's vibrant cultural diversity.